

The development of practical skills is a fundamental and integral aspect of the study of any scientific subject. These skills not only enhance learners' understanding of the subject but also serve as a suitable preparation for the demands of studying biology at a higher level.

1.1 Practical skills assessed in a written examination

Practical skills are embedded throughout all sections of this specification.

Learners will be required to develop a range of practical skills throughout their course in preparation for the written examinations.

1.1.1 Planning

Learning outcomes	Additional guidance
<i>Learners should be able to demonstrate and apply their knowledge and understanding of:</i>	
(a) experimental design, including to solve problems set in a practical context	Including selection of suitable apparatus, equipment and techniques for the proposed experiment. Learners should be able to apply scientific knowledge based on the content of the specification to the practical context. HSW3
(b) identification of variables that must be controlled, where appropriate	
(c) evaluation that an experimental method is appropriate to meet the expected outcomes.	HSW6